

Madison Levine

Department of Agricultural and Consumer Economics
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Education

University of Illinois 2022–Present

Ph.D. in Agricultural and Applied Economics (Expected 2027)

Fields: Development Economics, Behavioral Economics, Agricultural Economics

University of San Francisco 2019

M.S., International and Development Economics

Saint Mary's College of California 2017

B.A., Economics

Publications

- [1] N.F. Meriggi, M. Voors, **M. Levine**, A.M. Mobarak, et al. [Last-Mile Delivery Increases Vaccine Uptake in Sierra Leone](#). *Nature*, 627: 612–619, 2024.
- [2] **M. Levine**, N.F. Meriggi, A.M. Mobarak, V. Ramakrishna, M. Voors, and U. Wadehra. [Gendered Disparities during the COVID-19 Crisis in Sierra Leone](#). *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 113: 567–571, 2023.
- [3] J.S. Solis Arce, S.S. Warren, N.F. Meriggi, **M. Levine**, et al. [COVID-19 Vaccine Acceptance and Hesitancy in Low- and Middle-Income Countries](#). *Nature Medicine*, 27: 1385–1394, 2021.

Working Papers

- [1] **M. Levine**, S. Janzen, B. Kramer, and K. Shikuku.
Loss Aversion and Agricultural Investment: Experimental Evidence from Smallholder Farmers in Kenya
Job Market Paper
- [2] B. Kramer, F. Cecchi, **M. Levine**, and L. Waithaka.
See It Grow: A Randomized Evaluation of a Digital Innovation to Improve Crop Insurance Contract Design [CGIAR Discussion Paper \(2025\)](#)

Work in Progress

- [1] B. Kramer, M. Braun, **M. Levine**, A. Owuor, and R. Hill.
Country demand for speed and flexibility in pre-arranged financing: Evidence from disaster risk financing simulations in five countries in Africa
- [2] B. Kramer, **M. Levine**, R. Mawia
Do Weather Shocks Affect Food Consumption Differently for Women and Men? Evidence from Smallholder Maize Farmers in Kenya

Research Experience

Consultant, International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI) Oct 2025–Feb 2026

Nairobi, Kenya (in residence)

Graduate Research Fellow, International Livestock Research Institute Jan 2025–Jun 2025

Nairobi, Kenya (in residence)

Research Assistant, University of Illinois 2024–2025

Urbana-Champaign, IL

Senior Research Associate, Wageningen University & Research 2019–2022

Freetown, Sierra Leone (in residence)

Data Analyst Consultant, WARC Group Mar 2020–Jun 2020

Freetown, Sierra Leone

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant, Intermediate Microeconomics (ACE 300), University of Illinois Fall 2025, Fall 2026

Teaching Assistant, World Food Economy (ACE 251), University of Illinois Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 111), University of San Francisco 2018–2019

Presentations and Invited Seminars

[1] *See It Grow: A Randomized Evaluation of a Digital Innovation to Improve Crop Insurance Contract Design*, Midwest International Economic Development Conference, 2026

[2] *Impacts of risk transfer on agricultural investments: A randomized trial on insurance contract design in Kenya*, AAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

[3] *Loss Aversion and Agricultural Investment: Experimental Evidence from Smallholder Farmers in Kenya*, AAEA Annual Meeting, 2026

[4] *Demand for Risk Management Tools*, ACRE Africa, Nairobi, Kenya 2025

Service, Grants and Awards

Journal Referee: American Journal of Agricultural Economics

Best Second Year Paper Award, University of Illinois 2024

Global Food Security Graduate Fellowship, University of Illinois \$4,000 2024

Graduate Student International Research Grant, University of Illinois \$6,720 2024

Skills

Programming: Stata (proficient), Python (intermediate), R (intermediate)

Tools: L^AT_EX, Android Studio, Flutter, QGIS

Survey Platforms: SurveyCTO, ODK, Survey Solutions, Kobo

Languages: English (native), Spanish (intermediate)

References

Sarah Janzen (Chair)

Associate Professor

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Berber Kramer

Senior Research Fellow

IFPRI

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Hope Michelson

Professor

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